```
Scenario: Transferring money to a savings account
    Given I have a current account with 1000.00
    And I have a savings account with 2000.00
    When I transfer 500.00 from my current account to my savings account
    Then I should have 500.00 in my current account
    And I should have 2500.00 in my savings account
```

Examples play a primary role in BDD, simply because they're an extremely effective way of communicating clear, precise, and unambiguous requirements. Specifications written in natural language are, as it turns out, a terribly poor way of communicating requirements, because there's so much space for ambiguity, assumptions, and misunderstandings. Examples are a great way to overcome these limitations and clarify the requirements.

Examples are also a great way to explore and expand your knowledge. When a user proposes an example of how a feature should behave, project team members often ask for extra examples to illustrate corner cases, explore edge cases, or clarify assumptions. Testers are particularly good at this, which is why it's so valuable for them to be involved at this stage of the project.

A Gherkin primer

Most BDD tools that we'll look at in this book use a format generally known as Gherkin, or a very close variation on this format used by JBehave.[17] This format is designed to be both easily understandable for business stakeholders and easy to automate using dedicated BDD tools such as Cucumber and JBehave. This way, it both documents your requirements and runs your automated tests.

In Gherkin, the requirements related to a particular feature are grouped into a single text file called a *feature file*. A feature file contains a short description of the feature, followed by a number of scenarios, or formalized examples of how a feature works.

```
Feature: Transferring money between accounts
  In order to manage my money more efficiently
  As a bank client
  I want to transfer funds between my accounts whenever I need to

  Scenario: Transferring money to a savings account
    Given my Current account has a balance of 1000.00
    And my Savings account has a balance of 2000.00
    When I transfer 500.00 from my Current account to my Savings account
    Then I should have 500.00 in my Current account
    And I should have 2500.00 in my Savings account
  Scenario: Transferring with insufficient funds
    Given my Current account has a balance of 1000.00
    And my Savings account has a balance of 2000.00
    When I transfer 1500.00 from my Current account to my Savings account
    Then I should receive an 'insufficient funds' error
    Then I should have 1000.00 in my Current account
    And I should have 2000.00 in my Savings account
```

[17] Strictly speaking, Gherkin refers to the format recognized by the Cucumber family of BDD automation tools (see http://cukes.info). For simplicity, we'll use the term *Gherkin* to refer to both variations, and I'll indicate any differences as we come across them.